PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Land Rover LR4 / Discovery 4

2009–2016 (US: 2010–2016) · L319 · LR4 · Discovery 4 · 5.0 V8

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Coolant smell, coolant top-ups, crossover history**
  The plastic coolant crossover pipes and manifolds are the LR4's best-known weak point on both the 5.0 V8 and the 3.0 SC V6. Owners report failures from about 50,000 miles and treat 60,000–90,000 miles as replacement time. A sweet coolant smell after a drive, a falling expansion tank or a 'low coolant' message means it's already started. Ask for invoices showing genuine crossover pipes, the water pump and the thermostat.

- [ ] **5.0 V8: cold-start rattle**
  Land Rover bulletin LTB00474 covers a rattle or click from the front of the engine on 2010–2012 MY LR4s in VIN range AA513326–CA652214, caused by worn timing-chain tensioner levers. The fix is two tensioners (LR051008) and two levers (LR051013); the revised levers have a steel insert, and old and new parts must not be mixed. Listen to a stone-cold start, and get proof of the work if the VIN is in range. A ticking roughly once a second is more likely the fan clutch.

- [ ] **Air suspension: the overnight test**
  Raise the truck to off-road height, then check that it stays level overnight and that the compressor doesn't run constantly. A truck that sags after a few days has a leak at a strut, valve block or Voss fitting. Owners trace leaks with soapy water. If the compressor has been replaced, Arnott notes that the LR3/LR4 unit needs a software update and a new relay.

- [ ] **Which drivetrain do you have?**
  Every 2010–2013 US LR4 has a two-speed transfer box. From 2014 the base truck is single-speed with a Torsen centre differential, and low range plus the active rear locker came only with the $1,350 Heavy Duty package, which also brought a full-size spare. Owners check the 4×4 information screen (a single centre-lock icon means no HD package) and the spare, and look under the rear axle for the locker's actuator motor.

- [ ] **3.0 SC V6: supercharger rattle**
  A rattle like gravel in a can from the top of the engine at idle is usually the supercharger's spring-type coupler isolator wearing out. A supercharger rebuilder quoted on LandRoverWorld says it starts going at around 50,000 miles. It isn't urgent, but the supercharger has to be partly dismantled or removed, so it pairs naturally with the rear coolant manifold job.

- [ ] **Front lower control arms and brakes**
  At 5,600-plus lb, the LR4 is hard on lower control-arm bushings, ball joints and brakes. Clunks over bumps, steering wander and uneven tyre wear point at the arms. Owners say brakes wear quickly and cost a lot to replace, and early trucks had a TSB for rear brake squeal when reversing.

- [ ] **Recalls**
  Run the VIN through NHTSA. Every 2010–2016 LR4 is in campaign 21V635000 for a fuel-pump flange that can crack and leak. Some 2012–2013 trucks built in August–September 2012 are in 15V386000 for panoramic-roof adhesive, and some 2015s are in 15V214000 for ABS software that can disable stability control and Hill Descent Control.

- [ ] **Oil changes and records**
  The factory oil interval was 15,000 miles. Owners on LandRoverWorld and Expedition Portal recommend 5,000–7,500 miles, and some link the 5.0 chain-guide wear to long intervals. A truck with dealer stamps at 15,000 miles and no chain or cooling work is a project priced as a driver.

YEARS TO KNOW

2010–13 MY	BEWARE	5.0 V8 timing-chain tensioners and levers wear: bulletin LTB00474 covers 2010–12 trucks in VIN range AA513326–CA652214, revised parts start at VIN DA696315 (mid-2013), and a US class action covered 2012–14 5.0 trucks. Buy only with the invoice

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- [ ] **Fuel pump outlet flange may crack and leak**
  2010–2016 · NHTSA 21V635000
- [ ] **Panoramic roof adhesive may not hold**
  2012–2013 · NHTSA 15V386000
- [ ] **ABS software can disable stability and descent control**
  2015 · NHTSA 15V214000
- [ ] **Wheel lug nuts may crack**
  2015 · NHTSA 15V092000
- [ ] **TPMS may not learn sensor positions**
  2013–2014 · NHTSA 14V618000
- [ ] **Driver frontal airbag may not inflate properly**
  2016 · NHTSA 16V444000

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **Model year from the VIN**
  Land Rover quotes VIN ranges by their last eight characters, which begin with the model-year letter: A = 2010, B = 2011, C = 2012, D = 2013, E = 2014, F = 2015, G = 2016. That's the 10th VIN character under US federal rules. Use it to check a 5.0 V8 against bulletin LTB00474's range AA513326–CA652214.
- [ ] **Engine**
  2010–2013 US trucks have the 5.0 V8; 2014–2016 have the 3.0 supercharged V6. A diesel Discovery 4 in the US is not a factory US vehicle.
- [ ] **Low range and rear locker**
  All 2010–2013 US trucks have the two-speed transfer box. On 2014–16 trucks, low range and the active rear locker came only with the Heavy Duty package. Owners check the 4×4 information screen (a single centre-lock icon means no HD package), the spare (HD added a full-size one) and the rear diff for the locker's actuator motor. Owners don't agree on whether every 2010–2013 truck has the rear locker, so check physically or with a VIN decode.
- [ ] **Late trims**
  For 2016.5, owners report that the HSE Silver and HSE Landmark replaced the HSE and HSE Lux; Landmark trucks have Landmark badging, bright silver roof rails and 20-inch split-spoke wheels.

- [ ] **Armoured Sentinel**
  Land Rover's factory-armoured Discovery 4 Sentinel (B6 protection) is described as almost indistinguishable from a standard truck, so a heavy, oddly specified D4 deserves a closer look.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/land-rover/lr4/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks